

MTSS OVERVIEW

The process for requesting academic and behavior support at Wendell Phillips 63.



● PROCESS OVERVIEW

THE REQUEST SEQUENCE

Bring the student to a collaborative culture meeting first. Try Tier 1 and collaborative supports together. Track for about three weeks. If the need continues, complete the **MTSS Behavior Request** and we build a plan.

You are not expected to carry any part of this sequence alone. The team works alongside you at every step.

Safety events skip all of this. Go straight to Level 3, secure safety, and contact the office now.

● SYSTEM STRUCTURE

ACADEMIC AND BEHAVIOR PATHWAYS

	ACADEMIC LANE	BEHAVIOR LANE
For	Reading, math, work completion, academic engagement	Behavior patterns, regulation, restorative needs
Tier 1	Core instruction, scaffolds, small-group support	Morning Meeting, positive narration, your Teacher Response toolkit
Tier 2	Targeted intervention group	DBRC, Check-In / Check-Out, SAIG, resiliency group
Tier 3	Intensive, individualized	Behavior plan, restorative conference, wraparound

If a student needs both, you complete one MTSS Behavior Request and they get one plan with one owner — never two plans that do not know about each other.

● CLASSIFICATION

BEHAVIOR LEVEL DEFINITIONS

LEVEL 1 · CLASSROOM-MANAGED

Minor, in-the-moment. Redirects, off-task, small conflicts.

Stays in class. Use your Teacher Response toolkit. No request needed.

LEVEL 2 · RESTORATIVE

A pattern that continues after Tier 1, and you can say what you tried. **Routes to the Restorative Room.** Complete the MTSS Behavior Request first.

LEVEL 3 · OFFICE / SAFETY

Aggression, hands on others, elopement, threats. **The office responds now.** Secure safety, contact the office immediately. Family contact and investigation follow. **Level 3 does not route to Restorative.**

● RESTORATIVE SUPPORT

TAP-IN AND TAP-OUT

TAP-IN

Support comes to you. **The student stays in your room.** Use this whenever it is workable — keeping a student with their class is almost always the better outcome, and a well-timed tap-in often prevents what would have become a tap-out.

TAP-OUT

The student leaves to the Restorative Room, regulates, and returns.

Both are on the MTSS Behavior Request. Both are tracked. Neither is a failure on your part.

• PRIOR TO SUBMISSION

THE BIAS PAUSE

Before requesting support for a subjective behavior — **defiance, disrespect, or disruption** — pause and ask:

Would I read this the same way for any student in my room?

This is not an accusation. Those three categories are where referral disproportionality shows up in every school that measures it, because all three require a judgment call about intent and tone. The pause is a design feature, not a suspicion about you. **If you are unsure, talk with a counselor before you request.**

• TIER 1 DOCUMENTATION

REQUIRED BEFORE SUBMISSION

- 1 Bring the student to a collaborative culture meeting.**
Before paperwork. This is where most concerns get solved.
- 2 Try Tier 1 supports**, with the team's help. Proximity, nonverbal cue, private redirect, offered choice, calm corner or break, changed task or scaffold, regulation strategy, restorative conversation, seat change, call home.
- 3 Track for about three weeks.** Rough notes are fine — dates and what you tried.

4

Complete the MTSS Behavior Request, if the need continues. It asks what you tried because you will already have the answer.

• AVAILABLE SUPPORTS

SECTION F REQUESTS

- Restorative support — tap-in or tap-out
- Collaborative culture meeting
- A DBRC
- Check-In / Check-Out
- Counselor check-in
- An MTSS behavior plan

You request these on the form. The multidisciplinary team decides and assigns an owner — that is what protects you from carrying a plan alone.

• REVIEW PROCESS

AFTER SUBMISSION

The multidisciplinary team — Director of Culture, counselors, support specialists — reviews **within 5 school days** and comes back to you with a decision and a named owner.

If you flagged it Urgent for a safety or crisis concern, you hear from someone the same day.

WHO TO FIND

Counselors: Kern, Flores · **Restorative Room** · **Assistant Deans**

Director of Student Support & School Culture: M. Williams

Behavior lane content from MTSS Behavior Request v1.0 (draft for review).

Academic lane pending the live Academic MTSS form.

QUESTIONS? **ASK.**

This is a living document. If a step does not work in practice, tell the Director of Culture so we can fix it. Edge cases and "is this actually a Level 2?" calls go to the counselors or to me — that is what we are here for, and asking is never an imposition.

M. Williams

Director of Student Support & School Culture

Matchbook Learning at Wendell Phillips School 63 · K-8

SAFE. RESPECTFUL. RESPONSIBLE.